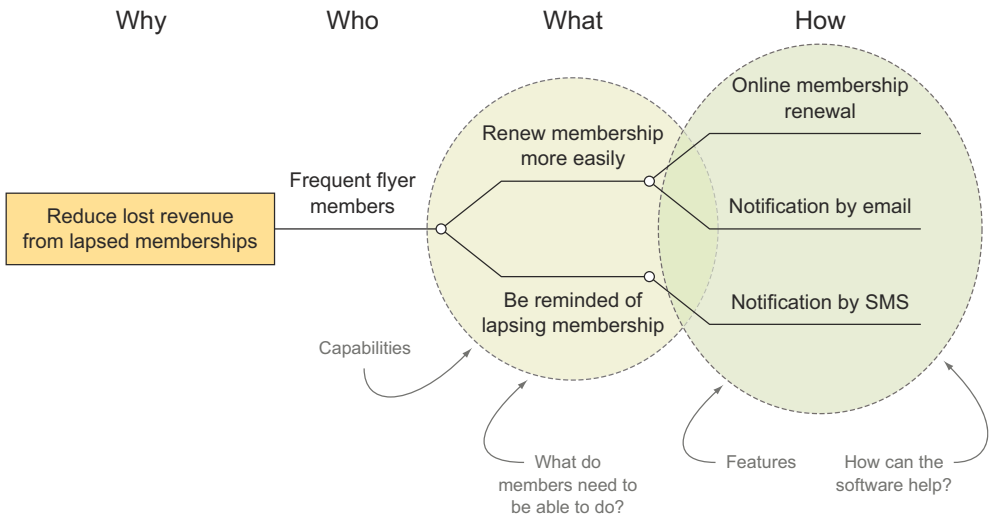


Figure 4.4 Features provide users or stakeholders with the capability to do something useful.

Let's focus on the online renewal feature. You could describe the "online membership renewal" feature using the "in order to ... as a ... I want" format, like this:

```
Feature: Online membership renewal
In order to renew my membership more easily
As a Frequent Flyer member
I want to be able to renew my membership online
```

❶ **A short summary of this feature.**
❷ **What capability or business goal are you supporting?**
❸ **Who is the main stakeholder that will benefit?**
❹ **What do you want to do?**

You used this format in the previous chapter to describe capabilities, but it works equally well for requirements at any level. You start off with a short summary or title of the feature to give some context ❶. This is the text proposed in the impact map in figure 4.4, in the "How" section. In fact, until you come to actually scheduling, designing, and implementing this feature, this short overview is usually enough to work with. You only really need to flesh out the details when you're fairly sure you want to (and are ready to) start working on the feature.

At that point, you can try to formulate what the feature is about in more detail. First you outline what business goal you think this feature will support ❷. This helps remind you why you're building this feature in the first place, and ties back nicely to the capability in the impact graph. It also allows you to do a sanity check on your requirement. You can ask yourself questions like, "Will the feature I'm proposing really help us achieve this business goal? If not, what business goal is it supporting? Based on what I know now, is it still worth building this feature?" Both your understanding of the requirements and the business context behind the project may have changed since you first envisaged the feature (see figure 4.5), and you might need to reevaluate how important the feature really is.